It was still early enough that she might have a chance to see André before he entered the factory for the morning shift. She passed a crowd gathered around a large red poster in the town square. Rose shuffled to the front to read the poster: *The Führer will avenge the people's suffering. Do not give up! In a few days, retaliation will come! Glorious victory to the Third Reich!*

She turned away from the crowd, her body ice cold. She needed André, to feel his warm hand in hers. He was lining up outside the factory. She signaled to him, and he followed her behind a building where they were out of sight.

"Have you heard?" she asked, breathless.

"About Dresden? Yes, it's horrible," he said, stroking Rose's cheek. "Don't worry. The war is almost over. Guys in my barracks are talking about running away. I'm listening, waiting for the right time. We'll do it together with Léa and Josef. Soon, we'll be home, together, and this will all be in our past." He bent down and kissed Katya on the forehead. "You're going to be a wonderful mother. Tell me again how many children we will have?"

Rose began to cry. She longed for the future André spoke of, yet she had already committed herself to Reinhardt. Her lips quivered as he drew closer and kissed her.

"We're in this together," he reassured her. "Don't worry. I love you, and we'll escape together." The factory bell chimed. He caressed her face, his hands radiating warmth. "I'll never leave you, I promise. I must go now."

"I love you, too," she said, watching him walk away. In her heart, she knew Reinhardt was right—she had to break it off with André—and she was running out of time.